

EDGE IN / VERDICT OUT

Edge Lab

User manual

How to use every screen: what to click, what to type, and how to read what comes back. The app itself shows only the numbers. The explanations are in this manual.

Version 2.16.0 · Windows and macOS · produced by [jiidc](#) · MIT licensed
Offline: no account, no telemetry, no network. Your journal stays on your machine.
Open this manual any time from the ? button at the top right of the app.

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Part 1 — Getting started

1. What Edge Lab does

Edge Lab answers two questions a prop trader has to get right:

- **Is my edge real?** Or is my record still explainable by luck?
- **How big should I trade?** What size passes this firm's evaluation, keeps the funded account alive, and pays me?

It has two modes, switched with the buttons at the top right:

MODE	USE IT TO
Journal	Log your trades, review them, and see what your record says: stats, strengths and leaks, timing, calendar, and how close each account is to its firm's rules.
Simulator	Run your edge thousands of times against a firm's rules: whether the edge is real, your odds of passing, your payouts once funded, and whether the challenge is worth buying.

The two modes connect through one switch, **Use my journal**. When it is on, the Simulator runs on your logged trades instead of the sliders.

2. The one unit: R

1R is the amount you planned to lose on a trade, the distance from entry to stop times your size. A trade that makes twice what you risked is **+2R**. A full stop-out is **-1R**. A trade closed at break-even is a **scratch** (0R).

Edge Lab works in R because R does not depend on account size. Your edge is the same whether you trade a \$25,000 or a \$150,000 account. Dollars come in at the end: set what 1R is worth (Journal) or your risk per trade (Simulator), and the app converts.

WHY IT MATTERS

A trade with no stop, no Risk \$ and no R override has no R. It still counts toward win rate and dollar totals, but every R statistic leaves it out. Log a stop or a Risk \$ on every trade.

3. The screen at a glance



The header: brand, mode switch, manual, reload, colour scheme.

CONTROL	WHAT IT DOES
Simulator / Journal	Switches mode. Each mode keeps its own state.
?	Opens this manual.
↻ (reload)	Reloads the app (F5). If a trade editor is open, it asks first.
• (colour scheme)	Picks a colour scheme: System (follows your OS), Daylight, Forest, Carbon, Midnight or Parchment.

Both modes share a layout: a **rail** of controls on the left and the **results** on the right. Change something on the left and the right side recalculates.

4. Quick start

- 1 Create an account.** In **Journal**, click **+ New** in Account scope. Name it after the prop account, e.g. "Apex 50k".
- 2 Log your trades.** Click **+ New trade** (**Ctrl+N**). At minimum: instrument, session, and a result (prices, or Risk \$ plus P&L, or an R value).
- 3 Set the firm.** Switch to **Simulator**, click **Edit rules** in The firm, pick a preset and match every field to your firm.
- 4 Turn on Use my journal.** It needs at least 10 resolved trades. The Simulator now runs on your record.
- 5 Read the four tabs in order:** Validate (is it real?) → Challenge (will it pass?) → Funded (will it pay?) → Decision (is it worth the fee?).
- 6 Bind the firm to the account.** Back in Journal, pick the account in Account scope and click **Bind sim firm** in Rule guard. The rule meters now track that account live.

Part 2 — Journal

The Journal: rail on the left, trade log on the right.

5. Accounts

Every trade belongs to one account. Keep **one journal account per prop account**. The rule guard and prop odds treat an account's trades as the real history of that account.

Account scope.

- **Create:** **+ New**, type a name, confirm.
- **Switch:** pick it in the Account scope dropdown. The log, stats, filters, equity and odds all follow the scope.
- **All accounts:** combines everything. Useful for overall stats. Rule guard needs a single account.
- **Delete:** select the account, click **Delete**, confirm. Its trades and screenshots are removed **permanently**. Export a backup first.

6. Logging a trade

Click **+ New trade** or press **Ctrl+N**. Save with **Save trade** or **Ctrl+Enter**. **Quick log** hides the deeper sections for fast capture. Switch back to the full form any time.

New trade

QUICK LOG

X

TRADE

DATE & TIME

09/25/2026 09:43 AM

INSTRUMENT *

Select...

DIRECTION

Long

SETUP / PLAYBOOK

Breakout, ORB, VWAP fade ...

ENTRY MODEL (OPTIONAL)

e.g. Liq sweep + CHOCH

SESSION *

Pick one...

ACCOUNT

Funded MNQ

EXECUTION

ENTRY

STOP

TARGET

EXIT

SIZE

EXIT DATE & TIME

mm/dd/yyyy --:-- --

Planned RR shows once entry, stop and target are set · risk 0.50% of account.

RESULT

RISK \$ (1R)

250

P&L \$ (NET)

auto

FEES \$

0

R OVERRIDE

auto

EXCURSIONS — HOW FAR IT RAN WHILE OPEN (OPTIONAL)

In R

In \$

In price

MFE (R IN FAVOUR)

optional

MAE (R AGAINST)

optional

MAE is entered as a positive number.

PLANNED R:R

e.g. 1.5

FULL RUN (R) — WINNERS ONLY

e.g. 4.2

TAGS

+0.00R

Cancel

Save trade

The trade editor (full form).

Trade

FIELD	WHAT TO ENTER
Date & time	When you entered. Used by Calendar, Timing and the rule guard's daily limits.
Instrument *	Required. Pick from the list or choose custom and type it.
Direction	Long or short.
Setup / playbook	Your name for the setup. Earlier ones are suggested as you type.
Entry model	Optional. The trigger you used (e.g. "Liq sweep + CHOCH"). Gets its own table in the Edge report and its own filter.
Session *	Required: Asia, London, New York or Other. It is a tag you pick, not read off the clock, so it stays right in any timezone.
Account	Which account the trade belongs to.

Execution

Entry, Stop, Target, Exit, Size	Prices and size. With entry and stop the app knows 1R. With a target too it shows the planned R:R. With an exit it computes the result.
Exit date & time	Optional. Enables holding time and the after-a-loss table on the Timing tab.

Result

Risk \$ (1R)	What one full loss would cost. Defaults to the account's R value if one is set.
P&L \$ (net)	Leave on <i>auto</i> and it fills itself as R × Risk \$ – fees . Type your own figure to override. Clear it to go back to auto.
Fees \$	Commissions for the trade.
R override	Type the R result directly if you journal without prices. Otherwise $R = P\&L \div \text{Risk \$}$.
MFE / MAE	Optional. How far the trade ran in your favour (MFE) and against you (MAE) while open. Enter in R, \$ or price with the switch. MAE is entered as a positive number : 0.6 means it sat 0.6R offside. \$ mode needs a Risk \$; price mode needs entry and stop.
Planned R:R	The target you set, in R. Type it here if you log without prices. It is derived automatically when entry, stop and target are filled.
Full run (R) – winners only	How far price got before it would have come back to your stop , whether or not you were still in. Losers need nothing: losing already proves the run fell short. This feeds the target sweep (section 11).

COMMON MIX-UP

Planned R:R is where your order sat, not how far price went. Putting the MFE in the Planned R:R box makes the target sweep report that your winners fell short of their own targets.

Tags, psychology, review, screenshots

- **Quality** (pick one): A+ setup, B setup, C setup, Forced, Revenge trade.
- **Mistakes** (any): Entered early/late, Sized too large, No stop, Moved stop, Exited early, Held too long, Outside plan, Chased, Overtraded.
- **Market conditions** (any): Trend day, Range / chop, High volatility, Low volume, News day, Open drive, Reversal.
- **Emotion before / after** (1 calm – 5 tilted) and **Followed the plan?** These feed the Edge report and the day guard.
- **Plan / thesis** and **Notes / review**: free text, searchable from the filter.
- **Screenshots**: click the drop zone, drag images in, or paste with `Ctrl+V` / `Paste from clipboard`.

7. The trade log

- Trades are grouped by day with a daily total. Click a trade to open its detail view.
- **Detail view**: `←` / `→` steps through trades. `Edit` opens the editor. Click a screenshot to zoom: scroll to zoom, drag to pan, double-click to fit.
- **Unit switch** (top right): show results in `R`, `P&L` or `Both`. P&L needs dollars turned on (section 9).
- **Bulk delete**: `Select`, tick trades or use `All`, then `Delete (n)`.

8. Filters

The Filter panel is a vertical sidebar on the left side of the application. It contains the following sections:

- FILTER** (header) with a **RESET** button.
- SEARCH NOTES & PLAN**: A text input field with the placeholder "anything you wrote ...".
- SETUP**: A dropdown menu currently showing "All setups".
- ENTRY MODEL**: Two buttons, "Failed breakout" and "Liq sweep + CHOCH".
- OUTCOME**: A dropdown menu currently showing "All".
- DIRECTION**: A dropdown menu currently showing "Both".
- SESSION**: A dropdown menu currently showing "Any session".
- MISTAKE TAG**: A dropdown menu currently showing "Any".
- MARKET CONDITION**: A dropdown menu currently showing "Any".
- INSTRUMENT CONTAINS**: A text input field with the placeholder "ES, EURUSD ...".
- FROM**: A date input field with the placeholder "mm/dd/yyyy" and a calendar icon.
- TO**: A date input field with the placeholder "mm/dd/yyyy" and a calendar icon.

The Filter panel.

Filters narrow the log **and every Stats tab**. Combine any of: text search (notes and plan), setup, entry model, outcome, direction, session, mistake tag, market condition, instrument, date range. **Reset** clears them all.

Clicking a row in the Edge report adds a **segment filter** chip above the log. Click its × to remove it.

9. Equity and dollars

The Equity panel is a vertical sidebar on the right side of the application. It contains the following sections:

- EQUITY** (header) with a **HIDE DOLLARS** button.
- Equity +68.7R · peak +68.7R · at the high**
- = \$67,200 on a \$50,000 start · +34.4%**
- STARTING BALANCE (\$) - FUNDED MNQ**: A text input field with the value "50000".
- WHAT 1R IS WORTH - FUNDED MNQ**: A text input field with the value "250".
- \$ per R** and **% of start** (two buttons).
- 1R = \$250 · 96 of 96 trades priced · 96 from logged P&L**

The Equity panel with dollars shown.

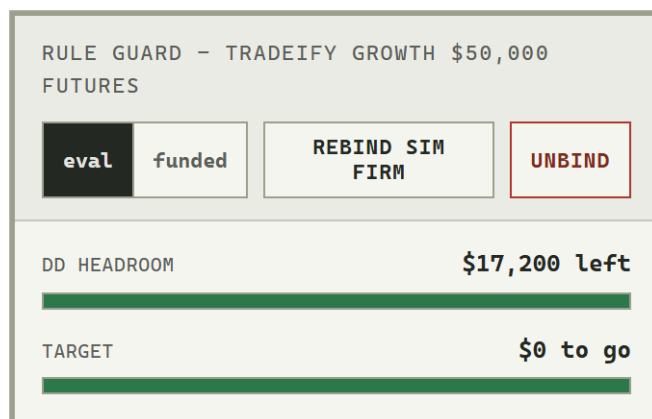
The journal works in R by default. To see money:

- 1 Pick a single account in Account scope.
- 2 Click **Show dollars** in the Equity panel.
- 3 Enter a **Starting balance**.
- 4 Enter **What 1R is worth**, either **\$ per R** (fixed dollars) or **% of start**.

Trades logged in R only are then priced at that value. Trades with a logged P&L keep their own figure. The line under the inputs says how many trades are priced.

On *All accounts*, combined dollars only work when every account has a balance and the same R value.

10. Rule guard



Rule guard on a bound account.

Rule guard shows how far this account is from breaking its firm's rules: drawdown headroom, today's loss against the daily limit, distance to target, min days and consistency.

- 1 Set the firm's rules in the Simulator (section 18).
- 2 In Journal, pick **one** account in Account scope.
- 3 Click **Bind sim firm**. The firm is now stored with this account. **Rebind sim firm** replaces it. **Unbind** removes it.
- 4 Set the phase: **eval** or **funded**. Funded replaces the target meter with payout readiness and starts counting from the funding date.

WHAT IT ASSUMES

That this journal account **is** the prop account: its trades are the trades placed there, at those sizes. On a general journal covering everything you trade, the meters describe an account that does not exist. Add a separate account per prop account.

Meters are computed from logged trade closes, not tick data. Keep a buffer on trailing rules.

The **day guard** line shows today's trades and R. It warns when you have 2+ losses in a row, 3+ losses today, or an elevated logged emotion. Stop for the day when you see it.

11. Stats — Performance



Stats → Performance.

How to read it

- **The four headline cards** are the edge: Expectancy, Win rate, Reward : risk, Profit factor. Expectancy is the one that grows the account. Win rate and reward:risk only mean something together.
- **Bands** (95% CI) under a number show how sure the sample is. If the expectancy band touches 0, luck is not ruled out yet.
- **The tile grid** adds trades, totals, balance, SQN, volatility, deepest drawdown, streaks, Kelly, recent form, best-day share and tail ratio. Each is defined in the glossary. These unlock at 8+ resolved trades.

- **Best-day share** matters for consistency rules. Many firms cap one day's share of profit near 30–50%.

Prop odds

Your journaled trades, resampled against the firm (the bound firm, or the Simulator's firm if none is bound), at the Decision tab's eval and funded risk. It shows pass odds, attempts and fees to fund, the chance to stay funded a year, the chance a purchase ends in a payout, expected payout, and sample quality. It needs 10 resolved trades. Under 50 trades, treat every range as directional.

Charts

- **Equity curve** in R, oldest to newest. **R-multiple distribution**: red losses, green wins.
- **Rolling expectancy** over a 30-trade window. A falling line means the edge is drifting or the market changed.

Exit management (needs MFE/MAE on 30+ trades)

- **Exit efficiency** = realised R ÷ best available R (MFE).
- **Avg MFE** is the average best point a trade reached. Compare it with your average winner: the gap is what your exits cost.
- **Avg heat (MAE)** is how far trades went against you on average. **Full-risk touches** near 100% mean stops fire late or get moved.
- **How far trades run — by session**: the band is the middle half of runs, the dark mark the median, the light mark the best 10%. **Kept** is the share of the run you realised.

Target sweep — what should the R:R be?

Your stop is 1R, so a target of **T** pays **+T** if the move reached T before coming back to the stop, and **−1R** if it did not. The sweep applies that to your record at every target and shows expectancy per trade.

- 1 Give every trade a **Planned R:R** (typed, or from entry/stop/target). If you traded one target throughout, type it in the **Planned R:R across this account** box and click **Set on n with none**. **Replace on all** overwrites every trade.
- 2 Log **Full run (R)** on your winners, at least 20 of them.
- 3 Read the **flat top**, not the single peak. Every target inside the flat top pays about the same; the lower end fills more often and pays sooner. The shaded range shows where 90% of resamples of your record put the best target.

DON'T SET THE TARGET TO YOUR AVERAGE MFE

The average sits above most trades. Every winner that peaks short of a higher target turns into a full **−1R** loss. Going from target P to T only pays if $p(T) \cdot (T+1) > p(P) \cdot (P+1)$. At a 48% win rate, moving 1.5R → 3R needs 63% of your current winners to also reach 3R.

The sweep starts at your lowest planned target: a trade that ran halfway and reversed is recorded only as a loss, so nothing below it can be measured. It assumes the stop stays put and that you would really hold to the new target. It follows the log filter, so filter to one setup or session to get a target for that subset. If runs are logged on under 80% of winners it warns you: logging runs mostly on big days biases it toward bigger targets.

12. Stats — Edge report

Edge Lab

EDGE IN / VERDICT OUT

Simulator

Journal

?

U

o

+ New trade Ctrl+N

Export backup

Import

ACCOUNT SCOPE

+ NEW

DELETE

Funded MNQ

RULE GUARD - TRADEIFY GROWTH \$50,000 FUTURES

eval

funded

REBIND SIM FIRM

UNBIND

DD HEADROOM

\$17,200 left

TARGET

\$0 to go

EQUITY

HIDE DOLLARS

Equity +68.7R · peak +68.7R · at the high

= \$67,200 on a \$50,000 start · +34.4%

STARTING BALANCE (\$) - FUNDED MNQ

50000

WHAT 1R IS WORTH - FUNDED MNQ

250

\$ per R

% of start

1R = \$250 · 96 of 96 trades priced · 96 from logged P&L

FILTER

RESET

SEARCH NOTES & PLAN

anything you wrote ...

SETUP

All setups

ENTRY MODEL

Failed breakout

Liq sweep + CHOCH

Session open drive

OUTCOME

All

DIRECTION

Both

SESSION

Any session

MISTAKE TAG

Any

MARKET CONDITION

Any

Trade log

Stats

Performance

Edge report

Timing

Calendar

EDGE REPORT - STRENGTHS & LEAKS

DISCIPLINE CHECK

Clean trades: +59.9R over 82 · trades with a tagged mistake: +8.9R over 14. Even your mistake trades are net positive — tighter is still better.

STRENGTHS - LEAN IN

LEAKS - CUT THESE

DIRECTION

LONG VS SHORT

All 96

Long 55

Short 41

ALL TRADES

96

57% of 89 decided trades won · 7 scratched

+68.7R total · PF 2.95

WIN STATISTICS

Winners

51

Best win

+3.33R

Average win

+2.04R

Avg win held

1h 3m

Longest win run

6

Gross wins

+103.9R

LOSS STATISTICS

Losers

38

Worst loss

-1.08R

Average loss

-0.93R

Avg loss held

1h 1m

Longest loss run

4

Gross losses

-35.2R

TOTAL R

LONG

+50.1R

SHORT

+18.6R

EXPECTANCY PER TRADE

LONG

+0.91R

SHORT

+0.45R

WIN RATE (0-100% SCALE)

LONG

65%

SHORT

47%

BY ENTRY MODEL

ENTRY MODEL	N	WIN%	RR	EXP	R
Session open drive	32	67%	1.90	+0.84	+26.8
Failed breakout	32	55%	2.16	+0.66	+21.1
Liq sweep + CHOCH	32	50%	2.65	+0.65	+20.8

RR = average winner ÷ average loser, in R. Resolved trades only; a row under 4 trades is noise.

BY SETUP

	N	WIN%	EXP	R		N	WIN%	EXP	R
Trend pullback	32	67%	+0.84	+26.8	A+ setup	51	100%	+2.04	+103.9
VWAP reclaim	32	55%	+0.66	+21.1	Forced	8	0%	-0.84	-6.7
Opening range break	32	50%	+0.65	+20.8	B setup	37	0%	-0.77	-28.5

BY SESSION - WHERE YOUR R COMES FROM

dashed ring = 0R

Stats → Edge report.

- **Discipline check:** clean trades against trades with a tagged mistake.
- **Strengths — lean in / Leaks — cut these:** every tag, grade, emotion, setup, session and direction with 4+ trades, ranked. **Click a row** to filter the log to those trades.
- **Direction:** long against short. Total R, expectancy and win rate side by side. The toggle picks which side's win/loss breakdown is shown. Under 8 trades a side, it's a hint, not a finding.
- **By entry model / setup / quality tag / session:** n, win%, RR (average winner ÷ average loser), expectancy, total R. Click an entry model row to filter the log. A row under 4 trades is noise.

- **By session radar:** where your R comes from. The dashed ring is 0R. Untagged trades count as Other. Open a trade and set its session to move it.

READ IT AS HYPOTHESES

With ~20 segments on screen, one will look best by chance. A leak is worth acting on when it has a real sample behind it and still holds after you log more trades.

13. Stats — Timing

Edge Lab

EDGE IN / VERDICT OUT

Simulator

Journal

?

U

o

+ New trade Ctrl+N

Export backup

Import

ACCOUNT SCOPE

+ NEW

DELETE

Funded MNQ

RULE GUARD - TRADEIFY GROWTH \$50,000 FUTURES

eval

funded

REBIND SIM FIRM

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WHAT 1R IS WORTH - FUNDED MNQ

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\$ per R

% of start

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FILTER

RESET

SEARCH NOTES & PLAN

anything you wrote...

SETUP

All setups

ENTRY MODEL

Failed breakout

Liq sweep + CHOCH

Session open drive

OUTCOME

All

Trade log

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DOES ANY OF IT HOLD UP?

NOTHING STANDS OUT YET

Tue (weekday): +0.05R over 12 vs +0.81R for the rest · gap -0.67R · noise floor 1.18R

BY ENTRY HOUR - YOUR CLOCK

HOUR	N	WIN%	RR	EXP	R	HELD	WIN / LOSS HELD	RAN TO (WON)	RAN TO (LOST)	EXPECTANCY ±1.00R
08:00-09:00	16	50% 27-73	3.26	+0.89	+14.2	1h 5m	1h 5m / 1h 10m	3.78R	1.52R	
09:00-10:00	16	63% 39-82	2.12	+0.90	+14.4	1h 5m	1h 8m / 1h 5m	3.49R	0.74R	
10:00-11:00	16	64% 39-84	1.91	+0.73	+11.7	1h 5m	1h 10m / 1h 5m	3.22R	1.39R	
11:00-12:00	16	50% 27-73	2.05	+0.41	+6.6	1h 5m	1h 10m / 1h 5m	2.68R	1.76R	
12:00-13:00	16	47% 25-70	2.19	+0.42	+6.7	1h 5m	1h 10m / 1h 5m	3.27R	1.00R	
13:00-14:00	16	69% 44-86	1.89	+0.95	+15.1	1h 5m	1h 10m / 1h 5m	3.08R	1.28R	

BY WEEKDAY

DAY	N	WIN%	RR	EXP	R	HELD	WIN / LOSS HELD	RAN TO (WON)	RAN TO (LOST)	EXPECTANCY ±1.50R
Mon	15	57% 33-79	2.40	+0.80	+12.0	1h 5m	1h 8m / 1h 5m	3.42R	1.38R	
Tue	12	42% 19-68	1.52	+0.05	+0.6	1h 5m	1h 5m / 1h 5m	2.66R	1.23R	
Wed	15	73% 48-89	2.21	+1.21	+18.2	1h 5m	1h 5m / 1h 8m	3.22R	1.42R	
Thu	15	54% 29-77	1.96	+0.51	+7.7	1h 5m	1h 10m / 1h 5m	3.53R	1.12R	
Fri	15	47% 25-70	2.81	+0.71	+10.7	1h 5m	1h 5m / 1h 5m	3.78R	1.47R	
Sat	12	80% 49-94	2.62	+1.30	+15.7	1h 8m	1h 8m / 1h 8m	3.16R	1.25R	
Sun	12	50% 24-76	1.83	+0.33	+3.9	1h 8m	1h 10m / 1h 5m	3.18R	1.14R	

BY HOLDING TIME

HELD FOR	N	WIN%	RR	EXP	R	HELD	WIN / LOSS HELD	RAN TO (WON)	RAN TO (LOST)	EXPECTANCY ±0.75R
15-60m	11	50% 24-76	2.39	+0.57	+6.2	25m	20m / 25m	3.54R	0.64R	
1-4h	85	58% 47-68	2.18	+0.74	+62.5	1h 5m	1h 10m / 1h 5m	3.25R	1.30R	

Stats → Timing.

The same record cut by clock: entry hour, weekday, holding time, which trade of the day, how long you waited after a loss, and how busy the day was.

"Does any of it hold up?"

The box at the top tests whether any one bucket really differs from the rest. It needs 30+ trades on an axis in 2+ buckets of 4+. It reports the most striking bucket, its gap against the rest, and the **noise floor**: the gap that

picking the best of that many buckets produces on a record with no timing edge at all. **Stands out** means the gap cleared both the 90% band and the noise floor. **Nothing stands out yet** means it didn't. Log more trades in the thin buckets rather than changing your trading.

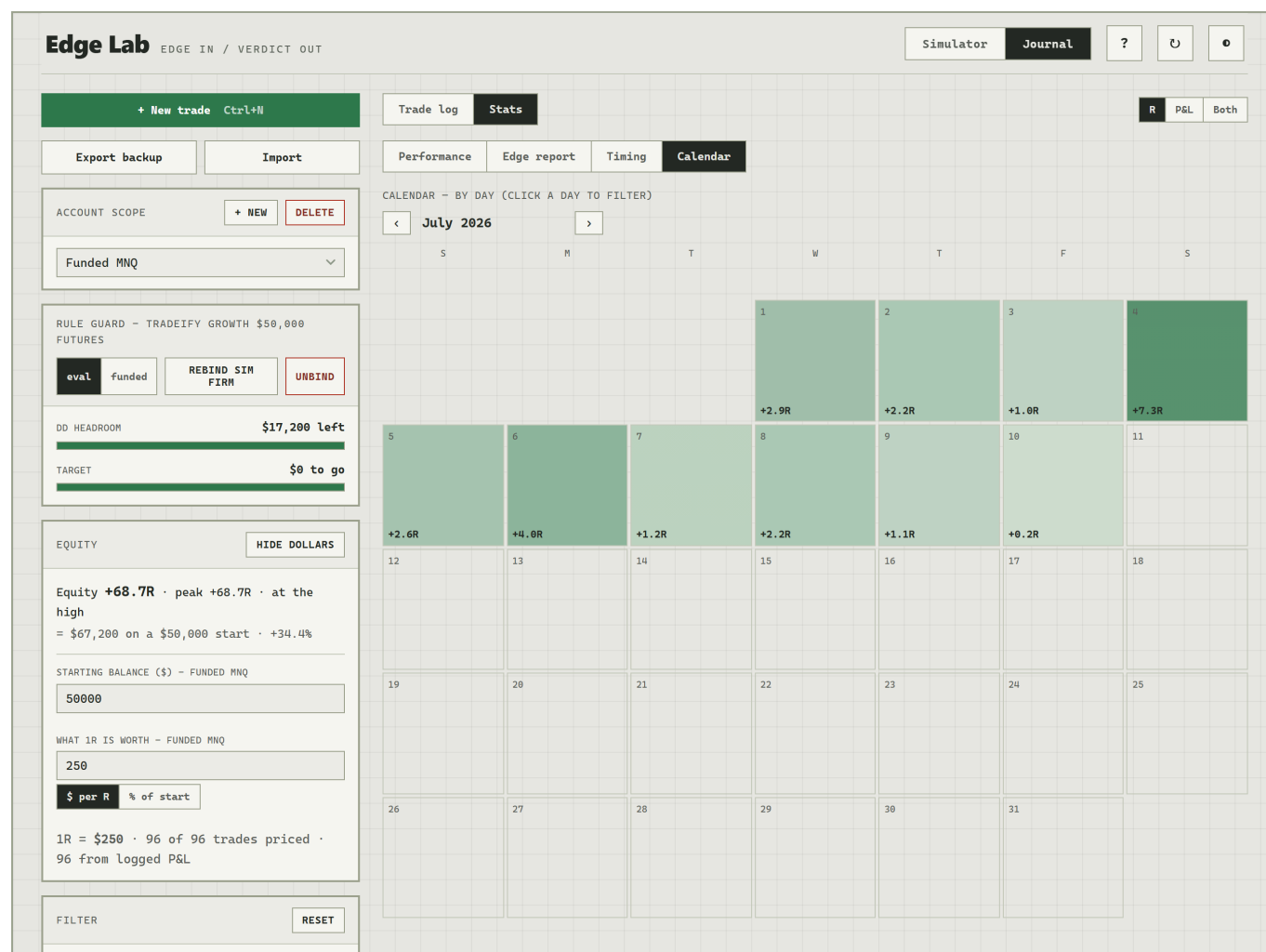
Even when a bucket stands out, an hour is *when* you traded, not *what*. Check the setup, session and direction mix inside it on the Edge report before changing anything.

Columns

win% (small range)	Win rate and its range.
RR	Average winner ÷ average loser, in R.
held / win / loss held	Median holding time. Needs exit times.
ran to (won) / (lost)	Median MFE, split by outcome. It says where price got, not whether you could have stayed in: MFE and MAE are stored with no order between them. Treat it as a reason to test a bigger target, not as a backtest of one.
expectancy bar	Expectancy per trade with its band.

- Hours are read straight from the times you logged, in your timezone. For market sessions use the session tag.
- **Holding time is never tested.** Winners run to target and are held longer, losers stop out fast, so long holds win by construction. It describes your trades; it is not an instruction to hold longer.
- **Which trade of the day** matters because the daily loss limit ends prop accounts. A decay down this column is a stopping rule, after it clears the test above.
- **After a loss** measures the gap from a losing exit to your next entry on the same account. It needs exit times on losers.
- **By how busy the day was** has one row per day (median day, green days, total R), not per trade.
- Blank cells mean the data isn't logged: holding time needs exit times, RR/kept needs a planned R:R, ran-to needs MFE.

14. Stats — Calendar



Stats → Calendar.

A month grid tinted by each day's result. Use < / > to change month. The unit switch shows R, P&L or both.

15. Backups and your data

- **Desktop app:** the journal is `journal.db` (SQLite) plus screenshots in `images\`, inside `Documents\PropEdgeLab\`. **Open folder** in the rail reveals it.
- **Browser version:** trades live in that browser only. Export backups often.
- **Export backup** writes a JSON file of every trade and setting. The app also makes a silent weekly backup into `exports\`.
- **Import** reads one of those backup files. You choose to **Merge** with the current journal or **Replace** it.



16. Your edge: sliders or journal

YOUR EDGE

sliders · win 55% · PF 1.22 · exp +0.10R

Win rate %

55

Reward to risk (R)

1

R:R

Profit factor

Scratch rate %

0

Trades in record

120

Your edge.

Sliders (default)

Win rate %	Share of decided trades that win. Scratches are outside it, the same as in the journal.
Reward to risk (R)	Average winner in R. Toggle Profit factor to enter PF instead.
Scratch rate %	Share of all trades that close at 0R. Scratches burn days without moving the account, which matters for time limits, subscriptions and payout windows.
Trades in record	How big a sample the numbers stand for. Controls how wide the ranges on Validate are.

Use my journal

USE MY JOURNAL

EDGE SOURCE

All accounts

LEAVE OUT (WHAT IF I STOP...)

Nothing – my whole record

Off — using the sliders.

Use my journal.

- 1 Turn on **Use my journal**. It needs 10+ resolved trades with an R basis.
- 2 Pick the **Edge source**: one account, or all.

Every tab now resamples your real trades instead of the sliders. Trades without a stop or Risk \$ are left out; the line under the switch says how many.

SEVERAL ACCOUNTS, ONE SIGNAL

If you fire the same trades into several accounts, pooling them counts one decision two or three times and makes every range look more certain than it is. Set Edge source to a single account. Validate flags pooled and mirrored trades.

17. Leave out (what if I stop...)

With Use my journal on, **Leave out** removes one segment of your record (the same segments as the Edge report, e.g. "Direction · Short"). Every tab then recomputes without it. The box below shows:

- the change in expectancy with its 90% band;
- the **noise floor**: how much cutting the most striking of that many segments moves a record when nothing is going on;
- a verdict: **Stands out, Inside the noise floor, Band includes zero** or **Barely moves the record**;
- a warning if survival drops. Fewer trades is a shorter record, not automatically a safer one.

Even "Stands out" is a hypothesis: you picked the segment by looking at these same trades. Trade it forward before believing it. Each segment you test is another look at the same record, so Validate widens its ranges for every look (see "Multiple looks" in section 23). Clearing the cut does not undo that. If the cut leaves fewer than 30 trades, it is not applied.

18. The firm and its rules

PRESET

(custom - as edited)

SAVE AS PRESET

QUICK ACCOUNT SIZE

\$5k

\$10k

\$25k

\$50k

\$100k

ACCOUNT SIZE (\$)

50000

STRUCTURE

Futures

INSTANT FUNDING

No - evaluation

TARGET PHASE 1 (%)

6

TARGET PHASE 2 (%)

5

MAX DRAWDOWN (%)

4

DRAWDOWN TYPE

Trailing end-of

TRAILING LOCKS AT START

Yes

DAILY LOSS LIMIT (%)

0

MIN TRADING DAYS

0

CONSISTENCY CAP (%)

0

TRADES PER DAY

3

PROFIT SPLIT (%)

90

TIME LIMIT (TRADING DAYS)

0

FEE TYPE

One-time

CHALLENGE FEE (\$)

299

ACTIVATION FEE (\$)

0

RESET FEE (\$, 0 = NONE)

0

PAYOUT EVERY (DAYS)

0

FIRST PAYOUT AFTER (DAYS)

0

MIN PAYOUT (\$)

0

PAYOUT BUFFER (\$ PROFIT)

3000

MAX PAYOUT (% OF PROFIT)

50

MAX PAYOUT (\$ PER REQUEST)

0

PAYOUT CONSISTENCY (% MAX DAY)

0

WINNING DAYS FOR PAYOUT

5

WINNING DAY IS (\$+)

150

0 = off.

The firm editor.

- 1
- Click **Edit rules** in The firm.
- 2
- Pick a **Preset** (2-step, 1-phase, Futures trailing, or one you saved) as a starting point.
- 3
- Set **every field** to match your actual firm. 0 turns a rule off.
- 4
- Optional: **Save as preset** to reuse it. **Delete preset** removes a saved one.

The **\$** / **%** switch shows the firm summary and the Funded tab in dollars or % of account. Decision is always in dollars.

FIELD	MEANING
Account size / quick chips	The funded account's size.
Structure	2-step, 1-phase or futures (one phase).
Instant funding	Yes = the fee buys the funded account outright. No evaluation; targets don't apply; the fee is a certain cost.
Target phase 1 / 2 (%)	Profit target per phase. Phase 2 starts from a fresh balance with full drawdown room.

Max drawdown (%)	Distance from the high-water mark (or start) to the floor.
Drawdown type	Static: floor fixed below the starting balance. Trailing intraday: floor follows the peak tick. Trailing end-of-day: floor follows the daily close.
Trailing locks at start	Yes = the trailing floor stops rising once it reaches the starting balance.
Daily loss limit (%)	Max loss in one day.
Min trading days	Days required before a pass counts.
Consistency cap (%)	Max share of total profit one day may contribute during the evaluation.
Trades per day	Your pace, 1–20. It sets when daily limits reset, how long a day is and how many trades fit in a year, so it changes almost every number.
Profit split (%)	Your share of payouts.
Time limit (trading days)	Days allowed per phase, in trading days (30 calendar days $\approx$ 21). 0 = none.
Fee type / Challenge fee	One-time, or monthly until passed (a subscription keeps charging while the evaluation runs).
Activation fee	One-off fee when the evaluation converts to funded.
Reset fee	Discounted re-attempt price after a failed evaluation (one-time-fee firms only). 0 = full fee every time.
Payout every / first payout after	Trading days between payout windows (0 = on demand) and before the first one.
Min payout (\$)	Minimum withdrawal. Only matters once it exceeds 5% of the account.
Payout buffer (\$ profit)	Profit the account must hold before any withdrawal (e.g. \$50k account pays only above \$53k = \$3,000 buffer).
Max payout (% of profit)	Most of current profit one withdrawal may take; the rest stays at the firm.
Max payout (\$ per request)	Fixed dollar ceiling per payout (the first tier if the firm tiers it).
Payout consistency (% max day)	Largest share of profit-since-last-payout any one day may contribute. A big day blocks withdrawals until later profit dilutes it; it does not fail the account.
Winning days for payout / Winning day is (\$+)	E.g. 5 days closing up \$150+ before a payout can be requested. The count resets after each payout.

CHECK THE RULES YOURSELF

Presets are starting points. Prop firm rules change often. Confirm every field on the firm's own site before you pay.

19. Validate — is your edge real?

Edge Lab
EDGE IN / VERDICT OUT

Simulator
Journal
?
U
O

YOUR EDGE FROM JOURNAL

96 journal trades · win 57% · PF 2.95 · exp +0.72R

Win rate % 57

Reward to risk (R) 2.20

R:R Profit factor

Scratch rate % 7

Trades in record 96

Is your edge real?

Likely real

STATISTICALLY REAL

The 95% range stays above zero.

WIN RATE, DECIDED	57%
	47–67% true
EXPECTANCY	+0.72R
	+0.41 to +1.02R
PROFIT FACTOR	2.95
	1.90–4.62
SAMPLE	96
	independent

trades cluster by day (3.0 a day)

USE MY JOURNAL ☐

EDGE SOURCE

All accounts

LEAVE OUT (WHAT IF I STOP...)

Nothing – my whole record

On — 96 trades from all accounts.

THE FIRM \$ % EDIT RULES

\$50,000 · target \$3,000 · trailing EOD
(locks at start) DD \$2,000 · no time limit
· fee \$299 · gates: \$3k buffer, 50% cap, 5 win days \$150+

1 Validate

2 Challenge

3 Funded

4 Decision

WHERE YOUR TRUE EXPECTANCY COULD BE

Shaded: 95% range (edges dashed) · red: break-even

DRAWDOWN TO PLAN FOR

Horizon (trades) 750

750 trades ≈ 250 trading days ≈ 12 months at 3.0/day

p50 · OVER 750

7.3R

COIN FLIP

p75 · OVER 750

8.8R

1 IN 4 WORSE

p90 · OVER 750

10.7R

SIZE TO THIS

p99 · OVER 750

15.5R

WORST CASE

Account drawdown limit % 0

0 = firm's 4% (\$2,000)

RESAMPLING

Block (fitted) Independent

no clustering (Lag-1 -0.19) · block 1

☒ USE REALISED LOSS SIZES

on · worst 5% of losses = 1.17x average

Solid p90 · dashed p99 · dotted p50 · vertical = horizon · 6,000 runs

LARGEST RISK PER TRADE THAT FITS INSIDE A 4.0% ACCOUNT LIMIT

0.34%

p95 drawdown over 750 trades: **11.9R** · Funded tab risk **0.50%** — **149% of the limit**

Not financial advice. Firm rules change — verify before paying. See the ? manual for how everything works.

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Validate.

Steps

- 1 Set your edge (sliders or journal).
- 2 Read the verdict: **Likely real**, **Promising**, **unproven**, **Not enough data** or **No edge**.
- 3 Set the drawdown **Horizon** (how many trades ahead you plan for) and, optionally, your own **Account drawdown limit %** (0 = the firm's).
- 4 Read the **largest risk per trade** box at the bottom.

Reading the verdict

- **Likely real:** the 95% range for expectancy stays above zero.
- **Promising, unproven:** the average is positive, but the range still crosses zero. More trades will settle it.
- **Not enough data:** under 30 trades. Aim for 100+. Everything below still prints; only the verdict holds back.

Each figure (win rate, expectancy, profit factor) has its range underneath. **Sample** shows the trade count and how many **independent** observations they amount to. Trades that cluster by day, setup or account are not separate draws, so every range is computed from the effective count.

The **curve** is where your true average trade could sit. The shaded band is the 95% range, with its edges marked by dashed lines in the band's colour; the red dashed line is break-even. If the band crosses break-even, you cannot yet rule out having no edge.

Drawdown to plan for

Maximum drawdown grows with how long you trade (roughly with log of trades), so every number names its horizon and percentile. Your record is resampled first, then the future simulated from each resample, so the answer covers the edge you might actually have, not just the one you measured.

p50 – coin flip	The median. Not a plan.
p75 – 1 in 4 worse	One run in four is deeper.
p90 – size to this	The sizing anchor.
p99 – worst case	The bad year. Size to survive it.

On the chart: solid line p90, dashed p99, dotted p50; the vertical line is your horizon. Every point is the same edge. The curve rises because a longer run has more chances to go wrong.

- **Resampling — Block (fitted)** keeps runs of consecutive trades together, so clustered losses survive the resampling. The block length is fitted from your record's lag-1 autocorrelation. **Independent** draws each trade separately and understates drawdown when losses cluster. The line under it shows the fitted block and, if clustered, what independent draws would have said.
- **Use realised loss sizes:** on = losses are resampled at the sizes you actually logged, so a stop that filled at $-1.4R$ can happen again. Off = every loss is your average loss. If all your logged losses are the same size, your journal records planned losses, not fills.

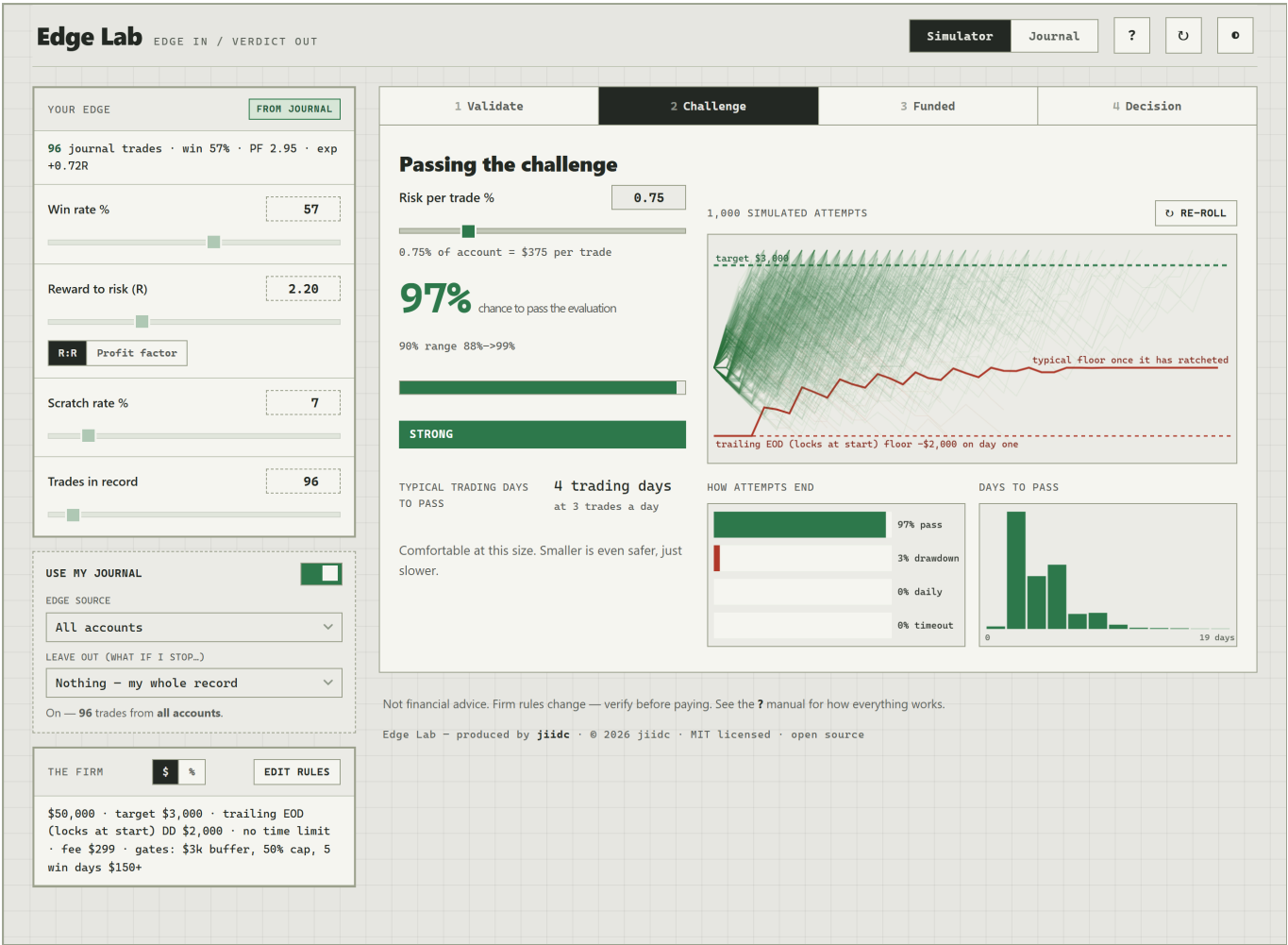
Largest risk per trade

The risk per trade at which the p95 drawdown over your horizon exactly fills the account limit. It is shown in green if the Funded tab's risk is inside it, red if not, with how much of the limit a 1-in-20 bad run would use. One run in twenty is still worse, so treat it as a ceiling, not a target.

Warnings on this tab

- **Multiple looks:** you have tested several subsets with Leave out, so ranges are widened (each is a stricter interval, so the whole family still carries 95%).
- **Pooled accounts:** the edge pools several accounts; mirrored trades (same instrument and direction within 5 minutes in different accounts) are discounted.
- **The full record, for comparison:** shown whenever a Leave-out cut is active.

20. Challenge — will it pass?



Challenge.

- 1 Set **Risk per trade %** for the evaluation.
 - 2 Read **chance to pass**, its 90% range, and typical trading days to pass.
 - 3 Read the one-line advice under it (see below).
 - 4 Use **re-roll** to draw a new sample of paths. On a 2-step firm, **Phase 1** / **Phase 2** switches which phase is drawn.
- **Paths chart:** each line is a live trade-by-trade walk of your edge against the rules. The pass figure itself averages 2,600 attempts.
 - **How attempts end:** pass, drawdown, daily limit, timeout. On a 2-step firm the faded end of a bar is failure in phase 2.
 - **Days to pass:** trading days, not calendar days; the total across both phases on a 2-step. The time limit applies per phase.
 - **Pass phase 1 × then pass phase 2** multiply into the headline on a 2-step firm.

ADVICE LINE	WHAT TO DO
Too big. Smaller risk lifts these odds a lot.	Lower risk per trade.

Smaller is worse here...

A smaller size is slower, and the time limit or min days is what fails you. Don't size down; the clock is the constraint.

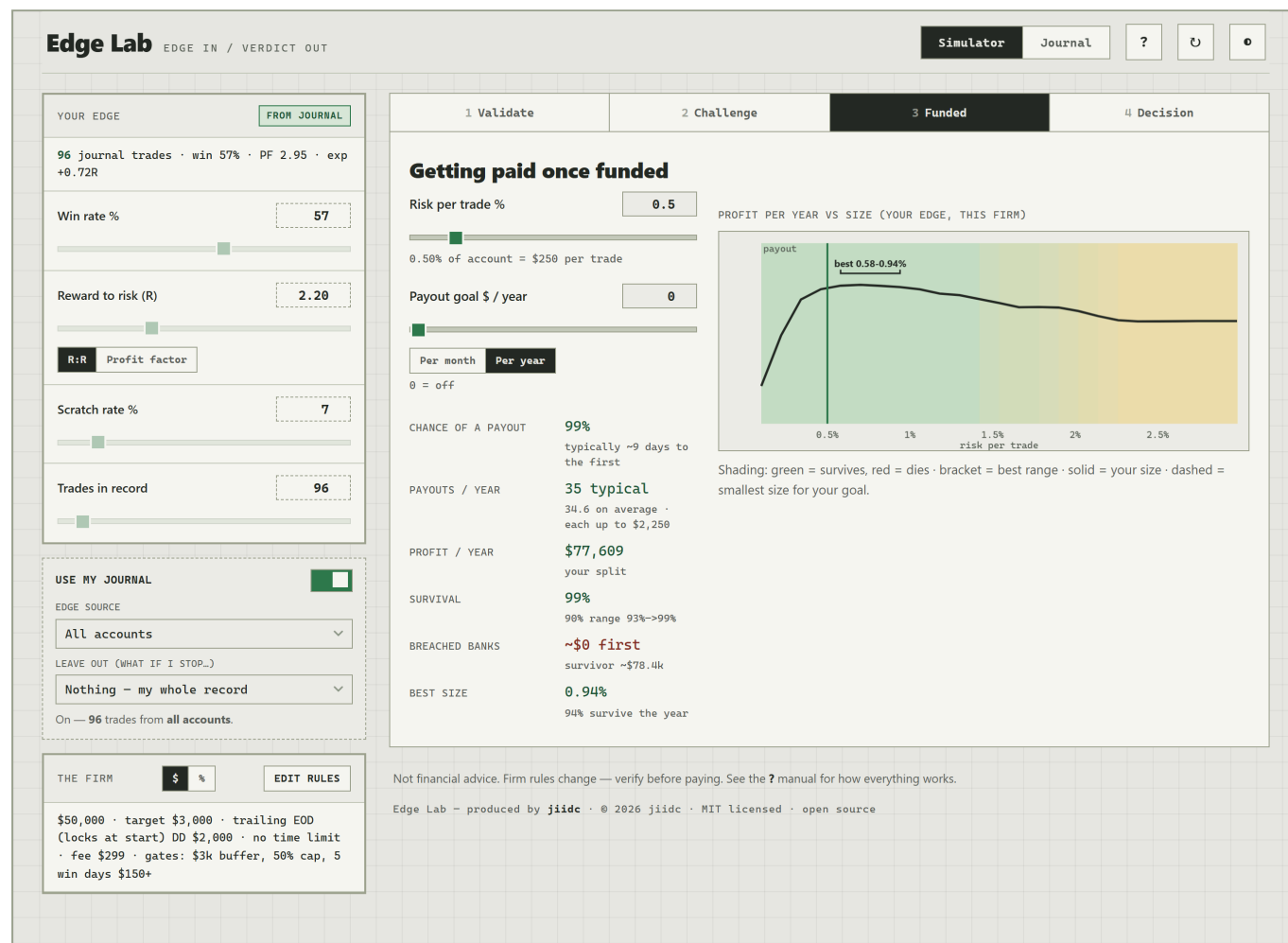
Size isn't the lever.

The firm's rules or your edge decide it. Try another firm or improve the edge.

Phase 1/2 is the harder gate

Which phase kills most attempts on a 2-step firm.

21. Funded — will it pay?



Funded.

- 1 Set **Risk per trade %** for the funded account. Most traders size down after passing.
- 2 Optional: set a **Payout goal** per month or per year. 0 = off. The slider moves in whole payouts.
- 3 Read the results and the chart.

Chance of a payout

Chance of at least one withdrawal inside the year, including the first-payout wait and minimum.

Payouts / year

Typical (median) and average count. Each payout is up to 5% of the account.

Profit / year

Cash actually withdrawn, averaged over every account including the ones that blew up. In \$ mode it is after your split; in % mode, before.

Survival

Accounts still alive after 252 trading days.

Breached banks

Median cash an account that breaches had withdrawn before it died, beside a survivor's. Shown when survival is under 100%.

Best size	The largest size whose profit is within 3% of the best and where 85+ accounts in 100 survive the year. Hidden under 30 trades.
Smallest size for goal	The smallest size whose odds of reaching your goal are within 3% of the best.

Chart: profit per year against size. It rises, flattens, then falls as accounts start dying. The background shades with survival: green survives, red dies. The bracket marks the flat top: sizes that pay within 3% of the best, but that do **not** survive the same. The solid line is your size; a dashed line marks the smallest size for your goal.

THE WITHDRAWAL HABIT THIS TAB ASSUMES

Up to 5% of the account is swept every 5 trading days, **never out of the drawdown cushion**. On a static or locked-trailing floor, a sweep only happens if the account stays a full max-drawdown above its floor afterwards: on \$50,000 with a \$2,000 drawdown, \$2,000 stays in and the first withdrawal needs about \$4,500 of profit. That retained cushion is most of what "Survival" measures. Keeping \$500 less costs about 16 points of survival; \$1,000 less costs about 51. If you sweep down to the firm's minimum, the survival figure does not describe you. On an **unlocked** trailing floor nothing is retained, because the floor follows the withdrawal down.

Payout gates (buffer, % cap, \$ cap, consistency, winning days) are applied exactly as the firm would. Payout **cadence** is shown but not priced. Trades are drawn independently: no tilt, no streaks, no sizing up after a loss.

22. Decision — is it worth buying?

Decision.

- 1 Set **Eval risk / trade %** and **Funded risk / trade %**. These two also drive the journal's prop odds.
- 2 Read **Net expected value of buying in** and its verdict: **Worth it**, **Not worth it**, or **Could go either way** (graded on the low end of the 90% range).
- 3 If it's not worth it, read the line under the verdict: it names an eval size that would make it pay, or says no size will.

Chance to pass	End-to-end pass odds (both phases on a 2-step).
Expected fees to fund	Average cost to get funded, re-attempting until you pass: fees, resets, subscription months, activation.
Best eval size	The eval size that funds you for the least money, measured on this firm; where several cost the same, the quickest. Under a time limit or min days, a smaller size can cost more.
First-year payout	Expected withdrawals over a funded year, after split.
Pass → paid	Chance one purchase ends with money withdrawn; in brackets, the odds once funded and typical days to the first payout.
Net @ 1st payout	Where you stand the day of your first withdrawal: the odds of getting there × one payout, minus the cost to fund. A firm can be worth a year and still not have repaid its fee by then.

Budget to funded shows what to set aside to be 50%, 80% or 95% sure of getting funded, with attempts and months. Plan from these rather than the average when evaluations come out of savings. They assume attempts are independent; real traders tilt after failures, so treat them as floors.

The net EV assumes your edge is real (check Validate), that you re-attempt until funded, and about a year of trading. It ignores time value and taxes. Discounted resets are priced only when a Reset fee is set.

Part 4 — Reference

23. Messages you may see

MESSAGE	MEANING / WHAT TO DO
Needs 10 resolved trades	Use my journal, prop odds: log more trades with a stop or Risk \$.
More stats at 8+ resolved trades	The quant tiles (ranges, SQN, Kelly, streaks) unlock at 8.
No R basis	No trade in view has a stop, Risk \$ or R override. Add one.
Too few trades to judge. Aim for 100+.	Validate won't call an edge real under 30 trades.
Multiple looks	You've tested several Leave-out subsets; ranges are widened for it.
Pooled accounts / mirrored	Same signal in several accounts. Pick one account as Edge source.
No proven edge. Check Validate first.	Decision: expectancy ≤ 0 , so the fee funds the firm, not you.
Pass odds too low to budget	Decision budget can't be bounded. Fix the edge first.
too thin to size	Funded best size is withheld under 30 trades.
none survivable	Even the smallest size loses 15+ accounts in 100 a year. The edge has to change, not the size.
the firm caps you first	Your payout goal needs more payouts than the firm's window allows in a year. Bigger account, faster-paying firm, or smaller goal.
out of reach at every size	The goal is more than this edge produces in a year. It's an account-size problem; raising risk makes it worse.
Pick a single account to use.	Rule guard needs one account in scope, not All accounts.
No dollar basis	Rule guard: every rule is in dollars. Set what 1R is worth in Equity.
n of m trades are not in these meters	Some trades have no P&L, Risk \$ or R value, so the meters are optimistic . Set what 1R is worth.
No trades since funding	Account marked funded but nothing logged since. Log a trade or switch back to eval.
Day guard	Losing streak or tilt logged today. Stop for the day.
Not applied – only n trades left	Leave-out would leave under 30 trades. The full record is still used.
Too few trades to test timing	Timing test needs 30+ trades on an axis, 2+ buckets of 4+.
Nothing to sweep yet	Add a Planned R:R to your trades.
The planned R:R does not match...	Most winners paid less than their planned R:R. The field probably holds MFE; replace it.
Not enough logged runs to sweep on	Log Full run (R) on 20+ winners. Without runs, the curve would just peak at the target you already use.
Runs logged on only n% of winners	Logging runs mainly on big winners biases the sweep toward bigger targets.

Mixed targets – read the hits column	Trades aimed at different targets; lower rows use fewer trades.
n of m trades have no date / exit time	Those trades are missing from that Timing table.
Rules checked n days ago	Firm presets may be out of date. Verify on the firm's site.

24. What the model assumes

- **Your record is a fair sample of your future trading.** A record can't check this about itself.
- **Trades are drawn independently** in Challenge, Funded and Decision: no tilt, no streaks, no sizing up after a loss. (Validate's drawdown uses block resampling to keep clusters.)
- **The firm's published rules hold** as entered. Min days and consistency are modelled approximately.
- **Withdrawal habit:** up to 5% of the account every 5 trading days, never out of the drawdown cushion (section 21).
- **Not modelled:** payout cadence after the first payout, the risk of a firm not paying (collapse, rule changes, denied withdrawals), time value of money, taxes.
- **Why ranges, not single numbers:** every figure from your journal is re-run on resamples of your own record, so it shows the edge you might have, not just the one you measured. A range that crosses a line (zero, 85% survival) means the record can't yet say which side you're on.

Nothing in Edge Lab is financial advice, an endorsement or an affiliate link.

25. Glossary

R	What you planned to lose on one trade. All results are multiples of it.
Resolved / decided / scratch	Resolved = finished. Decided = a win or a loss. Scratch = closed at 0R, neither.
Win rate	Share of decided trades that won. On its own it decides nothing: 35% pays well if winners are 3× losers.
Expectancy	What one average trade is worth, in R. $+0.20R$ = every trade adds a fifth of one risk unit on average.
Reward : risk	Average winner ÷ average loser. With win rate, it is the edge.
Profit factor	Gross wins ÷ gross losses. Under 1 you pay to trade; 1.25–1.5 is workable; over 3 usually means a small sample or one big winner.
Total R / Total P&L	Everything added up, in R or money.
Balance	Starting balance plus every priced trade in the account , whatever the filter.
SQN	System Quality Number (Van Tharp): expectancy ÷ its volatility, scaled by sample size; graded at $n = 100$.
σ per trade	Spread of R outcomes. Higher = bumpier ride and deeper holes for the same expectancy.
Deepest drawdown so far	The worst peak-to-trough fall this record has taken. One realisation, not a floor; Validate gives the forward distribution.
Streaks	Longest win and loss runs. Size for the loss run.

Kelly f^*	The growth-maximising bet fraction, shown as the range your win-rate interval implies. Prop traders use a fraction of the lower end.
Recent form	Average R over the last 20 trades against the whole record.
Best-day share	How much profit came from one day, measured over windows the size of one evaluation target, the way firms measure it.
Tail ratio	Worst single loss $\div$ average loss. Above 2 = a stop didn't hold or got moved.
MFE / MAE	Maximum favourable / adverse excursion: how far a trade ran for and against you while open.
Full run	How far price got before it would have hit your stop, whether or not you were still in.
Exit efficiency	Realised R $\div$ MFE.
p50 / p90 / p95 / p99	Percentiles: the value that 50 / 90 / 95 / 99 runs in 100 stay within.
CI / band / range	The spread of plausible values given your sample.
Effective sample	How many independent observations your trades amount to after clustering.
Noise floor	How big a gap you get for free by picking the best of many buckets on a record with no real effect.
Flat top	Sizes or targets that pay within 3% of the best.
Static / trailing / EOD	Drawdown floor types; see section 18.
Pass $\rightarrow$ paid	One purchase all the way to money out.

26. Keyboard shortcuts

Ctrl+N	New trade (Journal).
Ctrl+Enter	Save the open trade.
Ctrl+V	Paste a screenshot into the open trade.
$\leftarrow$ / $\rightarrow$	Previous / next trade in the detail view; previous / next image in the zoom view.
+ / - / 0	Zoom in / out / fit in the image view.
Esc	Close the open dialog.
F5 / Ctrl+R	Reload the app.

On a Mac, use **Cmd** instead of **Ctrl**.

27. Troubleshooting

PROBLEM	FIX
R stats are empty	Trades need a stop, Risk \$ or R override.
No dollars anywhere	Pick one account, Show dollars , set starting balance and what 1R is worth.
Use my journal won't turn on	Needs 10 resolved trades with an R basis in the Edge source.
Rule guard shows nothing	Pick one account (not All accounts) and click Bind sim firm.
Timing columns blank	Log exit times (holding time), planned R:R (RR/kept), MFE (ran to).

Numbers jump slightly on each change	Monte Carlo noise. Quick previews run while you drag; full numbers land a moment after you stop.
The ? button says the manual isn't installed	Reinstall the latest build. In the browser version, keep this PDF in the same folder as the HTML file.
Journal missing after reinstall	The data lives in Documents\PropEdgeLab\, not in the app. Check that folder, or Import your latest backup from exports\.